

I TRIED INSTALLING macOS ON A DELL LATITUDE... AND MY LAPTOP SURVIVED (BARELY)

A 17-Year-Old's Hackintosh Disaster Movie (That Somehow Had a Happy Ending)

THE BACKSTORY (A.K.A. BAD DECISIONS 101)

It all started with Rohtu's video — a genuinely great YouTuber who decided to install macOS on his Windows PC with "absolutely no idea what he was doing." Spoiler: It worked.

I watched that video and thought: "If this guy can do it with zero experience, what's stopping me?"

Turns out? Everything. But I did it anyway because I have terrible impulse control and a burning desire to prove Apple wrong.

Shoutout to Rohtu — you're the reason I'm here.

THE VICTIM (R.I.P. ORIGINAL SCREEN)

Laptop: Dell Latitude 5410 (*now with 50 percent less screen resolution*)

CPU: Intel Core i5-10310U (*10th Gen Comet Lake*)

GPU: Intel UHD 620 (*integrated graphics doing their best*)

RAM: 16GB (*the only thing that didn't betray me*)

Storage: NVMe SSD (*internal, because I finally committed*)

Display: 1080p to 768p (*thanks to a pen-related incident*)

Audio: Realtek ALC3204 (*the reason I now have trust issues*)

THE PEN INCIDENT (A.K.A. HOW I LOST 1080p)

So here's the thing. I was frustrated. The audio wasn't working. The config.plist was broken. Again. And I had a pen in my hand.

You know where this is going.

I threw the pen. Not hard. Just a gentle toss of frustration. It wasn't aimed at the screen. It was aimed at the universe. The universe, however, had other plans.

The pen hit the screen. Dead center. Like a missile. Like it was trained to find the one spot that would destroy my display.

The screen shattered. Not completely — just enough to ruin my day, my week, and my 1080p resolution.

The service center replaced it with a 768p panel. Because apparently, the universe has a sense of humor.

Moral of the story: Don't throw pens. Especially not at your Hackintosh.

THE TOOLS (A.K.A. MY THERAPY BILL)

Open Core – The bootloader that's smarter than me

Open Core Simplify – The cheat code I didn't deserve

OCAT – Config editor that I broke 47 times

USBToolBox (UTBMap) – For mapping USB ports so they actually work

AppleALC, Lilu, WhateverGreen – The three musketeers of Hackintosh

itlwm + HeliPort – Wi-Fi that actually works (unlike my life choices)

HoRNDIS – Saved my sanity during recovery mode

modGRUBShell.efi – For hacking the BIOS (Dell, please don't read this)

THE JOURNEY (A.K.A. MY DOWNFALL)

Phase 1: The First Attempt (External SSD)

"Let's test this before I ruin my laptop."

Installed macOS on an external SSD because I have a survival instinct (it didn't last).

Problem: Wi-Fi died in recovery mode (Airportitlwm threw a tantrum).

Fix: Switched to itlwm.kext + HeliPort. Used HoRNDIS to tether my phone like a caveman discovering fire.

Outcome: Booted into macOS. It was alive. I felt like a god.

Phase 2: The Pen Incident (A.K.A. The Universe Said "No")

"This is fine." (It was NOT fine.)

Threw a pen in frustration. Hit the screen. Shattered it. (Yes, really.)

Laptop went to Dell service center for two weeks. (Two weeks of withdrawal symptoms.)

Workaround: Revived a Dell Inspiron 1420 with Linux Mint Xfce — a laptop that belongs in a museum, not on my desk.

Lost the macOS partition during this chaos. (*Cried a little. Maybe a lot.*)

Phase 3: The Comeback (Internal NVMe)

"Fine. I'll do it myself."

Rebuilt macOS directly on the internal NVMe. (Full commit. No turning back.)

Dual-boot setup: macOS (APFS) + Windows 11 (NTFS). (They're like divorced parents who share custody.)

Fixed the time sync bug (Windows uses local time; macOS uses UTC — they were fighting like siblings).

Outcome: macOS running natively. No external drive. No excuses. Just vibes.

Phase 4: Apple ID Activation (The First Boss Fight)

"Too many accounts were created by this Mac."

Problem: Apple caught me using a serial number that was shared by 500 other Hackintosh builders.

Fix: Generated a fresh serial, changed MLB/ROM/SystemUUID, and even changed my network port serials because I'm paranoid.

Outcome: Apple ID, iCloud, App Store working. iMessage? Still ignoring me. Rude.

Phase 5: The iCloud Notes Bomb (A.K.A. Why I'm Still Broke)

"2 MB to 40 GB? Who designed this?!"

Apple Notes bloat exploded from 2 MB to 40 GB, leaving me with 5 GB of free space.

System started crashing after a few hours because it was literally suffocating.

Fix: Cleared local Notes cache, disabled and re-enabled iCloud sync, and prayed to Steve Jobs.

Outcome: About 50 GB free. System stable. I can finally sleep at night.

WHAT WORKS (SURPRISINGLY)

Bootloader: OpenCore (stable, for now)

macOS: 26 "Tahoe" (the final Intel macOS — so emotional)

Display: 768p (*at least it turns on*)

Graphics: UHD 620 (*no lag — how? no clue*)

Wi-Fi: itlwm + HeliPort (*chaotic but functional*)

Ethernet: Working (*I honestly forgot I had this*)

Bluetooth: Working (*I can connect my headphones and ignore my problems*)

Apple ID / iCloud: Working (*Apple hasn't banned me yet*)

Dual-Boot: Windows 11 + macOS (*they're like roommates who tolerate each other*)

Storage: About 50 GB free (*I can finally breathe*)

Artificial Notch: Added (*because why not?*)

WHAT DOESN'T (A.K.A. MY ENEMY LIST)

Audio: Intel SST chip hates me. Workaround: Bluetooth or USB audio.

iMessage / FaceTime: Serial and ROM issue. I'll fix it. Eventually. Maybe.

HDMI: Not tested. It probably needs a sacrifice to the Hackintosh gods.

WHAT I LEARNED (A.K.A. THE HARD WAY)

OpenCore isn't magic — it's just a really fancy config file that I broke more times than I can count.

Kexts are like drivers, but they hate you more. They sense your fear.

BIOS patching is the hardest part. DVMT and CFG Lock are the gatekeepers of hell.

Apple ID activation is a game of serial number roulette. May the odds be ever in your favor.

iCloud Notes can and will destroy your storage if you look at it the wrong way.

Pens are dangerous. Especially when you're frustrated. (Learn from my mistakes.)

Patience is the real skill you develop. Either that or I've just lost my mind entirely.

THE FLEX (BECAUSE I EARNED IT)

Built a Hackintosh on a laptop (hard mode unlocked).

Threw a pen, broke the screen, and actually fixed it (twice — I'm a professional now).

Dual-boots Windows and macOS without them killing each other (peace treaty secured).

Added an artificial notch because I want my Dell to cosplay as a MacBook.

Runs Kali Linux in a VM (because I want to "hack" my WiFi, not because I know what I'm doing).

Survived a 40 GB Notes explosion (I've seen things).

Apple ID still works (I don't know how, but I'll take it).

And I'm 17. (Yes, I'm flexing. Deal with it.)

INSPIRATION

"I spent many hours trying to install macOS on my Windows PC. I had absolutely no idea what I was doing. Spoiler: It actually worked."

-Rohtu, YouTube

To Rohtu: You made this look easy. It was NOT easy. But thank you for giving me the worst and best idea of my life. You're a legend.

TOOLS AND RESOURCES (A.K.A. THE REASON I'M STILL SANE)

Dortania OpenCore Guide – The Bhagvad Gita of Hackintosh
OpenCore Simplify – For hardware detection and EFI generation
OCAT – For editing config.plist without breaking it (mostly)
USBToolBox (UTBMap) – For mapping USB ports like a pro
GenSMBIOS – Serial generator that saved my Apple ID
HeliPort – Wi-Fi manager for itlwm

FINAL WORDS

This project isn't about macOS. It's about proving to yourself that you can build something from nothing — even when it breaks, even when it refuses to boot, even when Apple's servers try to stop you.

You don't need a Mac to run macOS. You need patience, Google, and the willingness to try something stupid.

EPILOGUE: THE LESSON

If you're reading this and you want to build a Hackintosh:

Do it. (But don't blame me if you break something.)
Back up your EFI. (Learn from my mistakes.)
Reset NVRAM. (I can't stress this enough.)
Have a working USB drive. (You'll need it. Trust me.)
Don't throw pens at your screen. (Seriously. Just don't.)

The 17-Year-Old Who Built a Hackintosh (And Lived to Tell the Tale)

Hi, I'm **Chirag S Shetty**. I'm 17, I build things that shouldn't work, and I have a bad habit of throwing pens at laptops when the audio drivers refuse to cooperate. This is the story of how I installed macOS on a Dell Latitude 5410 — a machine that Apple would rather see running Windows, and a project that broke my screen, my sanity, and my config.plist about 47 times. Spoiler: It worked. Eventually. Shoutout to Rohtu on YouTube for the inspiration — you made it look easy. It was not easy. But hey, if you're reading this, you're probably about to try something stupid too. Welcome to the club.

BONUS: The Soundtrack (That I Played on Repeat)

Minecraft - Volume Alpha (for studying how to fail)
Interstellar OST (for dramatic effect)
Hitman - Situs Inversus (for stealth)
God of War Ragnarök (for "I'm about to conquer the world" energy)
Rohtu's video on loop (for motivation)

END OF DOCUMENT